

185 Capture animal tracks in sand

20
MINS

When the Sun goes down, creatures that have hidden during the day start to become active. If you want to know what animals come into your garden or backyard at night, set up this easy “track trap” to find out.

What you need

- Sand
- Piece of wood
- Dog food
- Saucer or small, shallow dish



1 Cover an area of lawn with sand. Smooth it out with a piece of wood. The sand should be at least 1 in (2.5 cm) deep.



2 Put the dish of dog food in the center of the sand area, but be careful not to step on the sand or you'll have to smooth out the surface again.



3 The next morning, check for tracks. Take pictures or make drawings so you can identify what animal left them behind.

186 Identify animal tracks

10
MINS

You can figure out to what family your visitor belongs by counting the number of toes on the front and hind feet, and whether the claws are visible. The most common are cats, dogs, rodents, and mustelids.



FRONT



HIND

CAT



FRONT



HIND

DOG



FRONT



HIND

MUSTELID



FRONT



HIND

RODENT